RESEARCH ARTICLE

When Does Hierarchical Video Memory Pay?

Reach–Fidelity Trade-offs under Fixed Context Budgets

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When Does Hierarchical Video Memory Pay?

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Keywords: long-horizon video prediction; context compression; hierarchical latent models; memory; observability; re-entry; diffusion transformer; reproducible evaluation.

Abstract

A bounded-context video predictor must choose both how much history to retain and how to represent it. We study temporal rate, spatial resolution and package depth as a controlled **context-packaging** design space. A panning-world instrument provides exact geometric observability at viewport re-entry, while a shared latent diffusion-transformer consumes flat or multistream packages at explicit token budgets.

On a hash-pinned untouched holdout, hierarchy is most effective when it alone reaches the relevant past: the registered 14-to-48-frame reach-band effects are +0.0980 and +0.0914 across two training seeds. One simultaneous comparison family confirms hierarchy at 896 and 1,152 context tokens, leaves 1,792 unresolved, and confirms flat full-resolution context at 2,432 and 3,072. In the frozen latent interface, 48 fine frames cost 3,072 tokens, whereas 48 coarse frames plus a two- or six-frame fine tail cost 896 or 1,152. The hierarchical packages therefore provide the same nominal 48-frame addressable reach with 2.67–3.43 times fewer context tokens, without implying equal information or equal prediction error.

The principal directions persist across sampler allocations and an independently trained codec, with reduced precision for the upper inversion. A preregistered long-rollout study replicates the early hierarchy benefit but not a seed-0 late inversion, and therefore fails to establish a stable trust boundary. In persistent-object long Moving-MNIST, hierarchy better preserves spatial support and trajectory continuity, whereas flat context better preserves digit identity; both systems remain difficult in absolute terms.

The result is conditional rather than architectural: first buy enough reach to include the memory-relevant past, then preserve the fidelity required by the task. Hierarchy pays in the tested reach-limited region; flat context recovers when fine detail, rather than temporal access, becomes limiting.

1. Introduction

1.1 The empirical problem

Hierarchical video models are often motivated by a plausible story: coarse state changes slowly, fine state renders detail, and a hierarchy should therefore retain longer history efficiently. That story is not yet an answer. A model can appear better because it sees more frames, receives a different prediction target, uses more inference work, or is evaluated on a metric that ignores its hallucinations. Conversely, a hierarchy can appear useless on a benchmark where every relevant object remains visible to a short context. Earlier recurrent, stochastic and latent video predictors established the importance of temporal state and multi-modal futures [Srivastava et al., 2015; Shi et al., 2015; Wang et al., 2017; Denton and Fergus, 2018; Lee et al., 2018], but their reported scores do not by themselves identify whether a later failure comes from insufficient temporal access, lossy state, or self-fed rollout.

This article begins with two primary explanatory questions and one robustness question rather than a claim that hierarchy must win:

1. **Reach:** when does the supplied context contain the past that determines a re-entering event?
2. **Fidelity:** when reach is available, how much task-relevant information survives the package?
3. **Self-fed reliability:** does an apparent late failure of stored information replicate across training seeds?

The experimental object is context packaging. “Hierarchy” denotes one family of packages—multiple rates, resolutions or depths—rather than the conclusion. This distinction lets a flat window, a spatially coarse stream, and a temporally subsampled full-resolution stream be compared as design choices under explicitly reported budgets. The controlled instrument is deliberately synthetic: it is designed to identify a reach mechanism, not to establish natural-video superiority or a production-scale world model.

1.2 Why aggregate evaluation is insufficient

Aggregate MSE on sparse synthetic video is dominated by background. MSE inside only the ground-truth foreground mask has the opposite blind spot: content hallucinated elsewhere is not penalized. Empty foreground frames also change its meaning if they silently fall back to full-frame MSE. Identity metrics based on left-to-right component order fail when objects cross, and analyses that retain only frames scorable by both arms select easy survivors.

We therefore separate populations and estimands. The core report includes full-frame, non-empty-GT-foreground, background and union-mask errors; foreground precision and recall; component misses, extras and overlap; and scoring coverage. Persistent-object studies use generator-provided identities

and one-to-one assignment. No single score is asked to represent fidelity, hallucination, localization and coverage simultaneously.

1.3 Research questions and predictions

RQ1 — Reach. For a fixed context-token budget, is the package advantage concentrated on frames whose relevant evidence lies inside the longer package's reach but outside the shorter package's reach? The effect should be larger in a pair-derived reach-differential band than in generic horizon bins. A result outside this band would weaken the mechanism even if an aggregate comparison remained positive.

RQ2 — Fidelity. Once both packages reach the relevant past, does higher spatial detail recover the advantage? We expect tested inversions as a flat full-resolution window approaches the same temporal span, without assuming monotonicity or a unique crossing between sampled budgets.

RQ3 — Package shape. Are temporal subsampling and spatial coarsening interchangeable ways to buy reach? Not necessarily: static off-screen content may favour sparse full-resolution storage; dynamically evolving or lower-detail content may favour another package. The present testbed locates one operating point rather than proving data-independent ordering.

RQ4 — Self-fed reliability. Does the seed-0 early-benefit/late-inversion pattern replicate under the same long-loop protocol? The preregistered prediction is an early positive and late negative hierarchy effect in at least one new seed; a failed replication demotes the boundary rather than triggering post-hoc localization experiments.

1.4 Contributions

The fourth article contributes:

1. a low-cost re-entry instrument with exact geometric observability, complete error metrics and pair-derived reach bands;
2. an untouched, simultaneous fixed-budget frontier showing where hierarchical reach pays and where flat full-resolution fidelity recovers;
3. package-shape, prediction-head, sampler-allocation and codec interventions that separate stable diffusion directions from training-seed and upper-frontier precision boundaries;
4. explicit-access and persistent-object boundary studies that distinguish geometric reach, support/continuity, identity fidelity and reliable reuse;
5. outcome-independent reporting of a failed trust-boundary replication, a confounded B1 configuration result and all protected negative or mixed outcomes.

Energy-based modelling and stochastic reversibility remain dissertation strands and supplementary context; they are not required to make this article's central claim.

1.5 Relation to prior work

Clockwork VAEs introduced hierarchies whose upper latent sequences update at slower rates and demonstrated long video prediction over sequences up to 1,000 frames [Saxena et al., 2021]. Dynamic latent hierarchies, TECO, MilliVid and flexible diffusion conditioning likewise pursue long-horizon generation through hierarchical state, latent temporal consistency, coarse-to-fine rollout or variable history [Zakharov et al., 2023; Yan et al., 2023; Chandratreya et al., 2026; Harvey et al., 2022]. MilliVid is the closest architectural comparator: it allocates a fixed or closely matched transformer sequence budget across hierarchical levels and flat/packed controls. The distinction is therefore not that prior hierarchy studies ignore token budgets. It is that the present study crosses explicit flat, spatial and temporal packages over several matched budgets, derives the affected population from exact observability geometry, and reports both lower and upper inversions under one simultaneous confirmation family. Clocked recurrence, variational temporal abstraction, multiscale prediction and nested long-video diffusion provide additional antecedents for representing different temporal rates [Koutník et al., 2014; Kim et al., 2019; Villar-Corrales et al., 2022; Yin et al., 2023]. Outside video, Transformer-XL, compressive memory and memorizing transformers illustrate the broader distinction between extending a flat attention window and retaining selected historical state [Dai et al., 2019; Rae et al., 2020; Wu et al., 2022].

The predictor also belongs to a well-established latent diffusion and transformer lineage: denoising diffusion supplies the stochastic objective [Ho et al., 2020], DDIM supplies the deterministic finite-step sampler [Song et al., 2021], latent diffusion moves denoising into a compressed representation [Rombach et al., 2022], and DiT supplies the token-transformer design [Peebles and Xie, 2023]. VideoGPT, FDM and TECO illustrate related ways to represent or condition long video sequences [Yan et al., 2021; Harvey et al., 2022; Yan et al., 2023]. These components are antecedents, not claimed inventions of this article.

Recent work makes it especially important not to claim that memory-focused evaluation or retrieval is absent. WorldPack combines compressed trajectory packing with retrieval and evaluates spatial consistency on LoopNav [Oshima et al., 2025]. CaR/SceneFly, MemLearner and GIM-World study compression or learned retrieval under annotated camera motion and occlusion [Peng et al., 2026; Yu et al., 2026; Wei et al., 2026]. MBench and MemoBench explicitly benchmark long-term entity/environment/causal memory or disappearance and reappearance [Zhang et al., 2026; Chen et al., 2026]. Long-context state-space world models and explicit spatial-memory models offer additional alternatives to retaining all history in a flat attention window [Po et al., 2025; Wu et al., 2025]. Self Forcing directly targets the mismatch between ground-truth-conditioned training and self-fed autoregressive inference [Huang et al., 2025], continuing the broader exposure-bias line represented by scheduled sampling and sequence-level training [Bengio et al., 2015; Ranzato et al., 2016].

The present contribution is narrower and complementary. It treats temporal rate, spatial resolution and depth as manipulable ways to package a bounded context; computes exact geometric observability from a controlled generator; and tests where longer reach helps and where lost fidelity reverses that benefit. The pose-indexed mosaic reference receives raw pixels and exact pose and is therefore reported separately from token-budget comparisons. Cross-paper numerical ranking is not attempted because datasets, context, decoders, horizons, samplers and endpoints are not protocol-equivalent.

Table 1 — Protocol positioning relative to representative long-memory video work. Binary yes/no cells are avoided where papers control different resource axes.

Work	Memory mechanism	Reported resource control	Observability instrument	Rollout/evaluation form	Role here
CW-VAE	clocked hierarchical latent state	temporal-factor/depth ablations; not an exact flat–hierarchical package-budget series	no pair-derived re-entry labels	long latent-dynamics prediction	temporal-hierarchy lineage
FDM	flexible sparse/long-range diffusion conditioning	fixed model window with alternative frame-generation/conditioning schedules	no pair-derived re-entry labels	previously sampled frames condition later samples	conditioning lineage
TECO	compressed latent sequence + temporal transformer	model/baseline comparison rather than a matched package frontier	benchmark scene revisitation, not analytic visibility labels	autoregressive latent prediction	long-consistency lineage
MilliVid	coarse-to-fine hierarchical latent rollout	fixed or closely matched sequence lengths; 3,072 context tokens in the principal hierarchical/packed comparison	long Minecraft revisitation, not pair-derived analytic bands	coarse-to-fine autoregressive diffusion rollout	closest modern hierarchy comparator
WorldPack	trajectory packing + retrieval	compressed-memory/model comparison; not this article's multi-budget package intervention	LoopNav benchmark rather than analytic visibility labels	long action-conditioned rollout	compressed-memory comparator
CaR / MemLearner / GIM-World	learned or geometry-conditioned retrieval	method-specific memory/compression controls	annotated, learned or distilled geometry	long interactive rollout	modern retrieval comparators
MBench / MemoBench	benchmark instruments	n/a	task-dependent benchmark labels	model-dependent	memory-evaluation context
Self	rollout-	training-distribution	no geometric reach	self-fed mismatch	self-fed

Work	Memory mechanism	Reported resource control	Observability instrument	Rollout/evaluation form	Role here
Forcing	distribution training	intervention rather than context packaging	instrument	explicitly targeted	mismatch intervention
This work	flat, spatial and temporal context packages	exact context/target/total tokens; matched and labelled near-matched pairs across a tested frontier	analytic LoopMom visibility and pair-derived reach bands	self-fed rollout plus untouched/robustness families	controlled reach–fidelity study

This table compares experimental roles, not scores. In particular, the later pose-indexed mosaic receives raw pixels and exact pose, so it is visually separated from the matched-budget neural comparisons.

2. Controlled instrument

2.1 Panning-world generator

A 64-pixel viewport moves over a wider toroidal world containing background texture and digit sprites at fixed world coordinates. Recorded actions and viewport positions determine when each world location was last visible. Under the primary loopmom operating point, a directed traversal returns relevant content after approximately 48 frames.

The generator provides exact **geometric observability**: whether the world region needed for the current re-entry appeared within a candidate context span. This is not called information-theoretic necessity because shared MNIST priors can make unseen glyph content statistically guessable. A stronger necessity experiment would use paired counterfactual worlds that are identical over the short context but differ at re-entry.

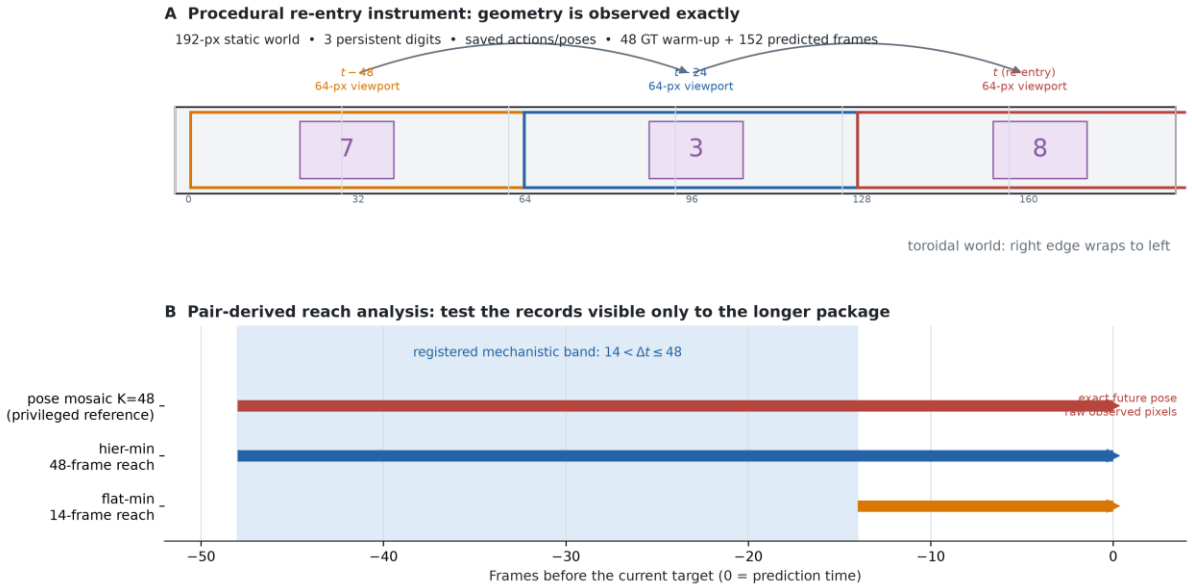


Figure 1. The 64-pixel viewport moves over a 192-pixel toroidal static world. Saved positions make geometric observability exact. The primary reach analysis evaluates records whose relevant content was observed 15–48 frames earlier: available to `hier-min`, unavailable to `flat-min`. The pose mosaic is visually separated because it also receives exact future pose and raw stored pixels.

2.2 Context packages and the B1 confound

Every package is described by context temporal stride, context spatial resolution, slots and reach, target stride and slots, auxiliary losses, context/target/total tokens, head and sampler allocation. The legacy B1 stride-2 arm couples context stride to coarse target stride. It therefore compares a complete stride-2 configuration to a short-flat configuration. We permanently retain that configuration-level interpretation in this article; a fixed-target control would be required only to revive a pure causal context-stride claim.

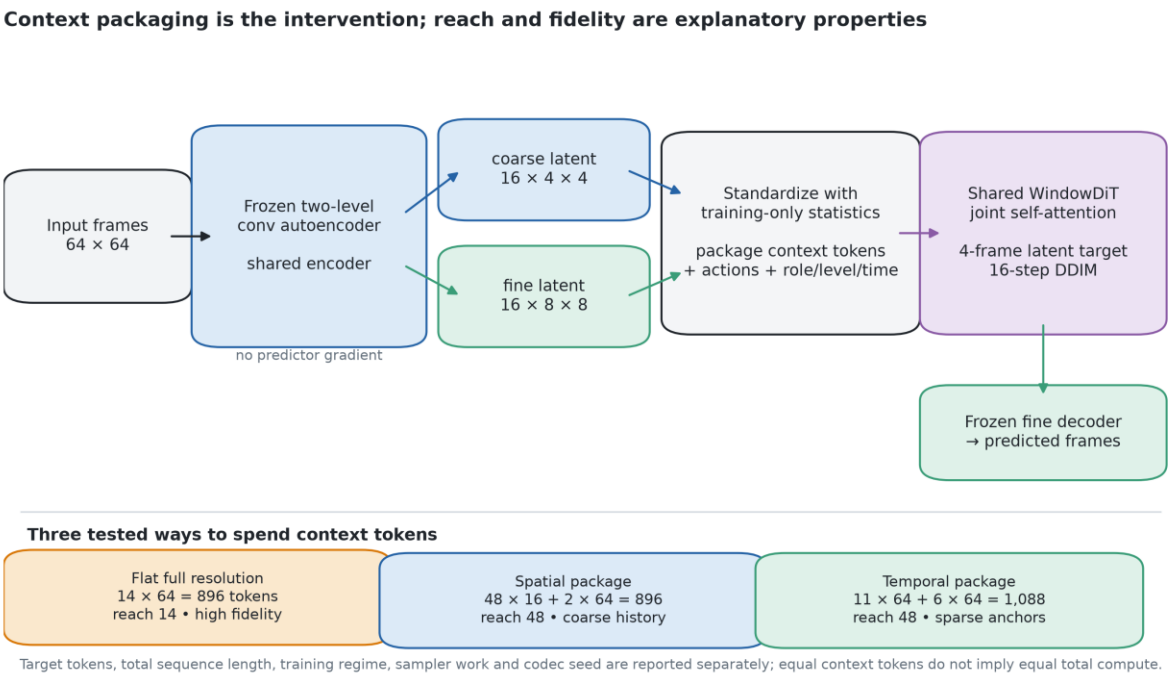


Figure 2. The predictor backbone and frozen two-level codec are shared while the context is packaged as contiguous fine frames, dense coarse history plus a recent fine tail, or sparse full-resolution anchors plus a recent tail. Reach and fidelity describe consequences of the package; they are not separately trained modules.

Table 2 — Exact interface accounting for the central configurations.

Arm	Package	Reach	Context tokens	Target tokens	Total tokens
`flat-min`	14 contiguous fine frames	14	896	320	1,216
`hier-min`	48 dense coarse + 2 fine	48	896	320	1,216
`flat-short`	8 contiguous fine frames	8	512	320	832
`hier-s2-min`	24 stride-2 coarse + 2 fine	48	512	288	800
`flat-budget`	18 contiguous fine frames	18	1,152	320	1,472
`hier-long`	48 dense coarse + 6 fine	48	1,152	320	1,472
`strided-flat`	11 stride-4 fine anchors + 6 fine	48	1,088	320	1,408
`flat-c1`	28 contiguous fine frames	28	1,792	320	2,112
`hier-c1`	48 dense coarse + 16 fine	48	1,792	320	2,112
`flat-c2`	38 contiguous fine frames	38	2,432	320	2,752

Arm	Package	Reach	Context tokens	Target tokens	Total tokens
`hier-c2`	48 dense coarse + 26 fine	48	2,432	320	2,752
`flat-long`	48 contiguous fine frames	48	3,072	320	3,392
`hier-rich`	48 dense coarse + 36 fine	48	3,072	320	3,392

The `strided-flat` package is near-matched, not exactly matched, to `hier-long`: it uses 64 fewer context tokens, a deficit that favors the temporal-package control. B1 changes 32 target tokens as well as the context, so its outcome remains a configuration effect.

2.3 Package, predictor and estimand

Let a context package be

$$\mathcal{P}_t = \{(\ell_i, s_i, n_i, a_i)\}_{i=1}^{L},$$

where ℓ_i identifies a representation level, s_i is temporal stride, n_i is the number of retained slots and a_i is the lag of the most recent anchor in stream i. The lag set is $K_i = \{a_i + js_i : j = 0, \dots, n_i - 1\}$. If a slot at level ℓ contains $q_\ell = H_\ell W_\ell$ tokens, the package cost and nominal addressable reach are

$$B_{\text{ctx}}(\mathcal{P}) = \sum_{i=1}^{L} n_i \, q_{\ell_i}, R(\mathcal{P}) = max_i[a_i + (n_i - 1)s_i].$$

This accounting makes reach exact but does not pretend that fidelity is one scalar: spatial resolution, codec distortion and temporal sparsity preserve different information. In the frozen interface $q_{\text{fine}} = 64$ and $q_{\text{coarse}} = 16$. Thus 48 fine slots cost 3,072 tokens, whereas 48 coarse slots plus two or six recent fine slots cost 896 or 1,152. If the target contains m_j slots at target level j, then $B_{\text{tgt}} = \sum_j m_j \, q_j$ and $B_{\text{total}} = B_{\text{ctx}} + B_{\text{tgt}}$. Claims about context efficiency refer to B_{ctx}; tables report all three quantities so they are not conflated with total sequence length.

The common predictor models a target latent block $z_{t+1:t+m}$ conditional on the packaged history and camera actions,

$$p_\theta(z_{t+1:t+m} \mid \mathcal{P}_t, u_{t+1:t+m}).$$

At diffusion time τ, clean coarse and fine target latents are perturbed as $z_\tau^\ell = \alpha_\tau z^\ell + \sigma_\tau \epsilon^\ell$ for $\ell \in \{\text{c}, \text{f}\}$. The executed head uses velocity targets $v_\tau^\ell = \alpha_\tau \epsilon^\ell - \sigma_\tau z^\ell$ and minimizes

$$\mathcal{L}_v = \mathbb{E}\big[MSE(v_\theta^{\text{c}}, v_\tau^{\text{c}}) + MSE(v_\theta^{\text{f}}, v_\tau^{\text{f}})\big],$$

where each level's MSE averages its batch, channel, target-frame and spatial entries before the two level means are summed. This follows the parameterization described by Salimans and Ho (2022). The regression control instead predicts the clean target latents directly. Effect signs are harmonized so that positive values always favor the registered candidate: comparator minus candidate for lower-is-better errors and candidate minus comparator for higher-is-better accuracy or coverage. For a long package $\mathcal{P}_l$ and shorter comparator $\mathcal{P}_s$, the reach-specific population is

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{reach}} = \{i: R(\mathcal{P}_s) < \Delta t_i \leq R(\mathcal{P}_l), \text{answerable}_i, \text{foreground}_i \neq \emptyset\}.$$

The evaluator constructs the foreground world-column set $F_i = \{(r_i + x) mod 192 : max_y g_i(y, x) > 0.5\}$ and the fixed six-frame novel set $N_i = F_i \setminus cov_6(i)$. If $v_i(c) = max\{u < i : c \text{ was visible at } u\}$ and $A_i = \{c \in N_i : v_i(c) \text{ exists}\}$, define, for $|N_i| > 0$,

$$\rho_i = \frac{|A_i|}{|N_i|}.$$

For $|A_i| > 0$, define

$$\Delta t_i = median_{c \in A_i}[i - v_i(c)].$$

Set $\rho_i = 0$ when $N_i = \emptyset$ and $\Delta t_i = 0$ when $A_i = \emptyset$. Define $answerable_i \Leftrightarrow |N_i| > 0 \wedge \rho_i \geq 0.5$. Columns, not foreground pixels, are the weighting unit. Thus records with no novel columns cannot enter a positive reach band, and records with no previously seen novel column are unanswerable.

The diffusion schedule follows Ho et al. (2020) and Nichol and Dhariwal (2021), deterministic sampling follows Song et al. (2021), and the latent-token transformer follows the DiT design family (Peebles and Xie, 2023).

2.4 Cost accounting

“Matched compute” is avoided unless total work is genuinely matched. Comparison tables list context tokens, target tokens, total sequence length, parameters, examples, optimizer updates, batch size, EMA, per-step and total NFE, runtime and peak memory. The B16x30k and B8x60k regimes process approximately the same examples but differ in updates, gradient noise, grouping and effective EMA horizon; c2 is an optimizer-regime robustness control.

Table 3 — Executed architecture, training, and evaluation settings.

Subsystem	Executed setting
Frozen codec	1.85 M-parameter two-level conv-AE; coarse $16 \times 4 \times 4$, fine $16 \times 8 \times 8$; each level independently decodable; per-channel, per-level training-set z-score
Rollout predictor	WindowDiT, width 384, 8 blocks, 6 heads, MLP ratio 4, full joint attention, adaLN-Zero;

Subsystem	Executed setting
	approximately 22.18–22.19 M trainable parameters across two-level arms
Target interface	four consecutive target frames; 80 coarse-plus-fine target tokens per frame (320 normally); action bound separately to each target frame
Diffusion / regression	$T = 1000$ clipped cosine schedule, v-prediction, deterministic DDIM-16 by default; regression uses summed per-level smooth-L1 and one forward pass
Optimization	AdamW, learning rate 3×10^{-4}, weight decay 10^{-4}, 2,000-update linear warm-up then constant rate, gradient clip 1.0, EMA 0.999; clean contexts; bf16 training
Training regimes	main B16×30k; disclosed optimizer-regime control B8×60k; both process approximately 480,000 examples but do not match update dynamics
Rollout evaluation	48 ground-truth warm-up frames; 38 four-frame steps = 152 self-fed targets; 100 clips per arm; common random numbers for paired stochastic comparisons

Table 4 — Exact context payload and materialized-embedding accounting at 48-frame reach. Each spatial token contains 16 frozen-codec coefficients; the rollout transformer has width $d = 384$.

Package	Context tokens	Latent payload, fp32	Latent payload, fp16/bf16	Width-384 embeddings, bf16	Relative cost
48 dense fine frames	3,072	192 KiB	96 KiB	2.250 MiB	1.00×
48 coarse + 6 fine	1,152	72 KiB	36 KiB	0.844 MiB	2.67× fewer
48 coarse + 2 fine	896	56 KiB	28 KiB	0.656 MiB	3.43× fewer

The latent columns are exact contiguous-array payloads. The embedding column is a model-implementation tensor; fp32 doubles it. These values exclude target tokens, attention and MLP intermediates, allocator/container overhead, parameters, optimizer state and activations. They therefore quantify stored context representations, not end-to-end training VRAM.

2.5 Development and confirmation populations

The existing test pool informed qualitative monitoring, arm selection and theory development. It provides development evidence, not an untouched final holdout. Confirmation uses a newly generated, hash-pinned set rejected by training and monitoring loaders. The analysis, thresholds, reach bands, table layouts and interpretation branches are frozen before access.

Table 5 — Publication-facing study map. "Seeds" denotes training seeds unless sampler or codec seeds are named explicitly. The licence limits what can be inferred from each study.

Study	Scientific role	Population / protected status	Intervention	Seeds	Inferential family	Terminal reading
Mechanism study	select a generation head by regime	LoopMom development / no	matched-capacity regression–diffusion interface plus a separate official-code EBM capability study	one regression, one diffusion, two EBM recipes	best-of-8 coverage and per-candidate NFE sensitivity with unequal total inference work; EBM diagnostic	diffusion for stochastic coverage; regression for deterministic rollout; EBM characterized negative
E2	confirm reach and the fixed-budget frontier	hash-pinned untouched LoopMom / yes	registered flat–hierarchical package pairs	pair-specific 0–2	one simultaneous frontier family plus frozen reach bands	hierarchy at 896/1,152; 1,792 unresolved; flat at 2,432/3,072
B1 within E2	test the complete stride-2 configuration	same E2 holdout / yes	512-token B1 versus `flat-short`	0–1	registered reach-band family	whole configuration confirmed; pure stride effect not identified
E4b	test head × package stability	adaptively used LoopMom pool / no	temporal versus spatial package crossed with diffusion/regression	0–4	per-seed clip intervals and seed-level t summaries	stable diffusion package direction; regression and interaction heterogeneous
E5a	replicate a late self-fed inversion	registered long-loop replication set	frozen long-reach pair at new seeds	0–2	fixed early/late contrasts	early benefit repeats; late inversion **NOT_REPLICATED**
E7c	sampler/NFE robustness	purpose-locked LoopMom set / yes	five sampler allocations on frozen seed-0 checkpoints	training 0; sampler 0–2	one 20-effect simultaneous family	directionally robust; upper inversion less precise
E7a	whole-codec robustness	purpose-locked LoopMom set /	independently trained codec, new normalization and retrained predictors	predictor 0; one alternate codec	one eight-effect simultaneous family	codec-directionally robust

Study	Scientific role	Population / protected status	Intervention	Seeds	Inferential family	Terminal reading
		yes				
E8a	explicit-addressing reference	purpose-locked LoopMom set / yes	raw warm-up mosaic queried with exact future pose	n/a	one six-effect simultaneous family	privileged access substantially lowers error
E6	persistent-object external boundary	protected long Moving-MNIST / yes	matched 1,152-token flat and hierarchical packages	0–2	one 15-effect simultaneous family	hierarchy support/continuity; flat identity; neither solves task

Rows labelled robustness, privileged reference or external boundary do not become extra cells in the E2 causal frontier. The supplementary configuration section reports the complete observed interface and cost fields and marks structurally absent cells explicitly.

3. Endpoints and inference

3.1 Complete frame metrics

For every frame record we save full-frame MSE; GT-foreground MSE only on non-empty frames; GT-background and union-mask MSE; foreground precision, recall and F1; component counts, misses, extras, IoU and centroid error. Empty-GT frames are a named stratum and never inherit a differently defined full-frame value under a foreground label. SSIM and PSNR are retained as conventional image-reconstruction diagnostics [Wang et al., 2004], while perceptual and distributional metrics such as LPIPS, FID and FVD motivate—but do not replace—the task-specific foreground, component and re-entry endpoints used here [Zhang et al., 2018; Heusel et al., 2017; Unterthiner et al., 2019].

The need for this suite is empirical rather than stylistic. On the exact archived 100-clip, 964-target CW-VAE Moving-MNIST population, a deterministic all-black predictor scores 0.7681 SSIM / 13.941 dB, compared with 0.5708 / 12.918 for the trained best-of-5 CW-VAE curve. Because only the model's mean curves survived, this is a hash-pinned same-population metric diagnostic without paired inference—not a budget-matched model ranking. It shows why sparse-background full-frame metrics cannot carry the memory claim. OpenSTL and modern deterministic predictors remain useful short-horizon competence references, but their aggregate benchmark protocols answer a different question from the registered re-entry populations used here [Gao et al., 2022; Tan et al., 2023].

3.2 Persistent-object metrics

Object claims require stable generator IDs, glyph classes, trajectories, boxes and overlaps. Predicted components are assigned jointly with a frozen Hungarian cost [Kuhn, 1955]. Misses receive a trajectory penalty, extras remain visible, and identity accuracy is intention-to-score over all labelled GT objects. Matched-only performance is diagnostic; coverage is co-primary.

Let $p, g \in [0,1]^{H\times W}$, $P_\tau = \{p > \tau\}$, $G_\tau = \{g > \tau\}$, $U_\tau = P_\tau \cup G_\tau$, and $e = (p-g)^2$. The four error endpoints are $\sum e/(HW)$, $\sum e\mathbf{1}_{G_\tau}/|G_\tau|$, $\sum e\mathbf{1}_{\neg G_\tau}/|\neg G_\tau|$, and $\sum e\mathbf{1}_{U_\tau}/|U_\tau|$ for full, foreground, background, and union MSE, respectively. Foreground MSE is undefined on empty GT masks and excluded from non-empty analyses; background and union MSE take value 0 on an empty denominator. Precision and recall each take value 1 when their own denominator is empty; F1 takes value 0 when precision plus recall is zero.

Table 6 — Reproducible endpoint and assignment rules. M is the number of accepted matches and $D = \sqrt{H^2 + W^2}$ is the frame diagonal.

Population	Instance rule	Assignment	Denominators and penalties
LoopMom frame	$\tau = 0.5$; masks defined above	none	pixel denominators above; foreground-empty records explicit
LoopMom component	connected components after threshold 0.5; minimum 4 pixels	Hungarian cost $1 - IoU$; discard zero-IoU pairs	misses $= n_{GT} - M$; extras $= n_{pred} - M$; IoU and centroid error over accepted matches
E6 persistent object	threshold 0.3; minimum 30 pixels; intensity-weighted detection centroid and component box; all detections classified (confidence threshold 0)	generator metadata supplies visible GT boxes and labels; q_g is the GT-box center; Hungarian cost $0.5min(\|q_g - q_d\|_2/D, 1) + 0.5(1 - IoU)$; accept cost ≤ 0.65	coverage $= M/n_{GT}$; trajectory $= [\sum_{\mathcal{M}} \| q_g - q_d\|_2 + (n_{GT} - M)D]/n_{GT}$; identity = correct accepted labels / visible labelled GT, so misses fail; extras remain explicit but are outside these two denominators

With no visible E6 GT object, coverage is 1 and trajectory error is 0; identity is undefined if no visible labelled GT exists. These conventions and the matched-only diagnostics are fixed before protected evaluation.

3.3 Pair-specific reach analysis

For reaches $r_s < r_l$, the mechanistic band is $r_s < \Delta t \leq r_l$, restricted to non-empty, geometrically answerable records. For `hier-min` versus `flat-min`, it is `14 < dt <= 48`; for stride-2 B1 versus `flat-`

`short`, `8 < dt <= 48`. These definitions were post-hoc on the development pool and were frozen as primary before the untouched E2 evaluation.

3.4 Statistical protocol

Effects are paired by clip and horizon; confidence intervals resample clips rather than autocorrelated frames. Reports show each seed, record/clip counts and coverage. Opposite seed-specific effects are heterogeneity even when their mean is near zero. Equivalence requires a justified smallest effect of interest and reliable measurement; otherwise a null interval is inconclusive. For clip c with retained frame records $i \in c$, the paired record differences d_{ci} are summarized by

$$\hat{\Delta} = \frac{\sum_c \sum_{i \in c} d_{ci}}{\sum_c n_c}.$$

Each bootstrap replicate samples clips with replacement and retains all selected frames inside each sampled clip. It therefore preserves within-rollout dependence rather than treating frames as independent observations [Efron, 1979; Cameron et al., 2008]. These clip-cluster intervals condition on a trained model. Training seeds are a separate uncertainty level and are displayed individually or summarized with seeds—not clips—as units.

Sampling robustness is evaluated separately from training-seed robustness. E7c freezes four already-supported seed-0 diffusion contrasts and five variants before evaluation: NFE 8/16/32 at sampler seed 0 and NFE 16 at sampler seeds 1/2. A 10,000-replicate studentized max-statistic clip-cluster bootstrap covers the resulting 20-effect family. This checkpoint-only design can test sensitivity to inference allocation and randomness; it cannot establish robustness to training seed, representation seed or another dataset family. Registered comparison families use the maximum absolute studentized statistic in each replicate, yielding simultaneous intervals that control the familywise error rate rather than interpreting many marginal intervals independently [Westfall and Young, 1993; Romano and Wolf, 2005].

4. Results

The main claim path is the untouched frontier (§4.1), the package-form boundary (§4.4), the failed replication (§4.5), and the persistent-object boundary (§4.9). Development evidence (§§4.2–4.3) explains how the confirmation was designed. Sampler, codec, and privileged-access studies (§§4.6–4.8) support scope and mechanism without redefining the primary frontier.

4.1 Untouched confirmation of reach and the fixed-budget frontier

On the frozen E2 holdout, `hier-min` versus `flat-min` yields +0.0980 [0.0788, 0.1179] and +0.0914 [0.0736, 0.1098] in the registered `14 < dt <= 48` band across seeds 0/1. The B1 configuration versus

`flat-short` yields +0.0692 [0.0543, 0.0845] and +0.0743 [0.0588, 0.0899] in `8 < dt <= 48`. Whole-population, union/full-frame, recall/F1, missed-component and coverage endpoints corroborate the signs. The concentration of the benefit inside the pair-derived reach band supports reach as the mechanism rather than horizon alone.

The single simultaneous frontier family confirms hierarchy at 896 and 1,152 tokens, leaves 1,792 unresolved, and confirms flat full-resolution context at 2,432 and 3,072. The largest tested family-wise-confirmed hierarchy point is therefore 1,152 tokens and the smallest tested confirmed flat point is 2,432. No value between them is inferred. The memory arithmetic is substantial: the confirmed hierarchical packages provide nominal 48-frame reach with 896 or 1,152 tokens, compared with 3,072 tokens for a 48-frame fine-only window. This is a 2.7–3.4-fold context-token reduction for reach, not a claim of equal information or equal error at every operating point.

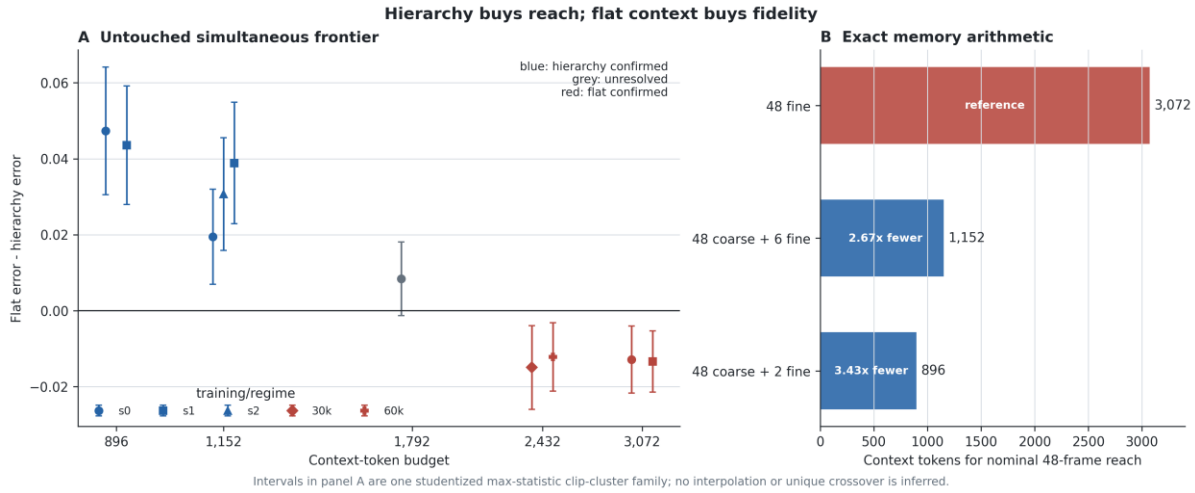


Figure 3. Left: untouched E2 effects under one studentized max-statistic clip-cluster family; positive favors hierarchy. Right: exact cost of 48 fine slots versus coarse history with a recent fine tail. The figure marks tested outcomes only and draws no interpolated crossing.

4.2 Development evidence that motivated the confirmation

On non-empty answerable development records, `hier-min` versus `flat-min` yields +0.0880 [0.0668, 0.1083] at seed 0 and +0.0809 [0.0621, 0.0998] at seed 1 in `14 < dt <= 48`. Stride-2 B1 versus `flat-short` yields +0.0675 [0.0526, 0.0828] and +0.0709 [0.0544, 0.0871] in `8 < dt <= 48`. These post-hoc observations motivated the frozen E2 analysis; they are not relabelled as confirmatory. Development comparisons also suggested an intermediate hierarchy region and an upper flat recovery. E2 preserved the lower and upper directions but correctly demoted the 1,792-token point to unresolved.

4.3 B1 configuration result

The stride-2 B1 configuration wins under diffusion by +0.0330 and +0.0338 across the completed seeds. Under regression, seed 0 yields +0.0639 [0.0516, 0.0763]. This is strong evidence for the whole configuration. It does not isolate context stride because target slots, target tokens, auxiliary loss, sequence length and optimization difficulty also change. The article retains configuration-level wording permanently within its present scope.

4.4 Temporal versus spatial packages and head interaction

The five-seed factorial gives a clean result under diffusion and a boundary under regression:

Seed	Diffusion temporal advantage	Regression temporal advantage	Head × package interaction
0	+0.0197 [+0.0143, +0.0252]	+0.0107 [+0.0062, +0.0158]	−0.0089 [−0.0151, −0.0025]
1	+0.0046 [+0.0007, +0.0084]	−0.0104 [−0.0146, −0.0062]	−0.0150 [−0.0199, −0.0104]
2	+0.0111 [+0.0070, +0.0151]	−0.0208 [−0.0270, −0.0150]	−0.0319 [−0.0401, −0.0245]
3	+0.0075 [+0.0037, +0.0114]	+0.0248 [+0.0181, +0.0323]	+0.0173 [+0.0106, +0.0245]
4	+0.0060 [+0.0027, +0.0092]	−0.0166 [−0.0229, −0.0108]	−0.0226 [−0.0297, −0.0160]

All five diffusion effects favor temporally sparse full-resolution context. Their across-training- seed mean is +0.0098, SD 0.0060, with t95 [+0.0023, +0.0173]. Regression instead has two temporal and three spatial material winners; its mean is −0.0024 with t95 [−0.0266, +0.0217]. The interaction also changes sign, with mean −0.0122 and t95 [−0.0353, +0.0109]. Consequently, the preregistered robust negative head-shift rule fails. The defensible conclusion is that the diffusion package result is stable across the five tested seeds, whereas package utilization under regression and cross-head generalization are training-seed-sensitive. This is not equivalence and not evidence for a directional head law. Clip-cluster intervals condition on each trained model; the t intervals use training seeds as units. Unlike E2, this factorial uses the existing adaptively used evaluation pool and is measured development evidence, not a new untouched confirmation.

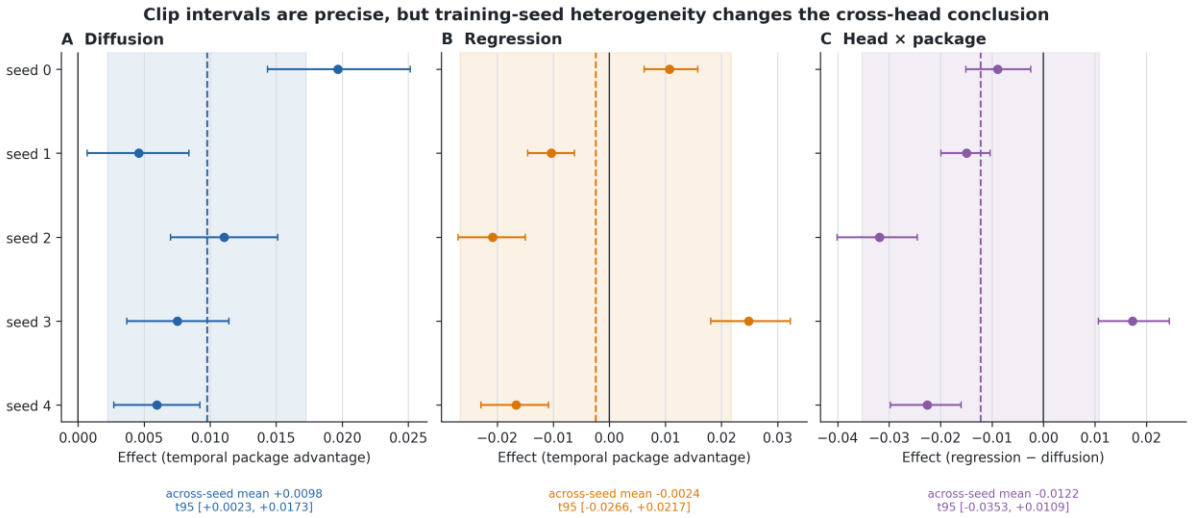


Figure 4. Clip-bootstrap intervals are conditional on a trained model and are shown per seed. The shaded interval and dashed mean instead summarize five training seeds. Diffusion consistently favors temporal anchors; regression and the interaction change sign.

4.5 Addressability and self-fed reliability: a negative replication

At a longer-loop operating point, single-step teacher-forced retrieval succeeds when span covers the loop. Seed 0 then shows an early hierarchy benefit followed by a late inversion during pure self-fed rollout. E5a preregistered that horizon pattern and repeated the same pair at two new training seeds. Positive effects below favor the 224-frame-reach hierarchy:

Training seed	Early h1–24 effect [95% CI]	Late h61–256 effect [95% CI]
0	+0.0204 [+0.0133, +0.0279]	−0.0064 [−0.0095, −0.0032]
1	+0.0082 [+0.0035, +0.0133]	+0.0074 [+0.0038, +0.0112]
2	+0.0230 [+0.0150, +0.0315]	+0.0087 [+0.0035, +0.0139]

The early advantage is positive and CI-clean at all three seeds. Neither new seed reproduces the required late-negative direction; both instead show a positive, CI-clean late hierarchy effect. The registered verdict is **NOT_REPLICATED**, so the gated horizon/refresh/corruption programme is not authorized. This result preserves the conceptual distinction between addressability and self-fed reliability while failing to establish a stable approximately-24-frame trust boundary in the current evidence.

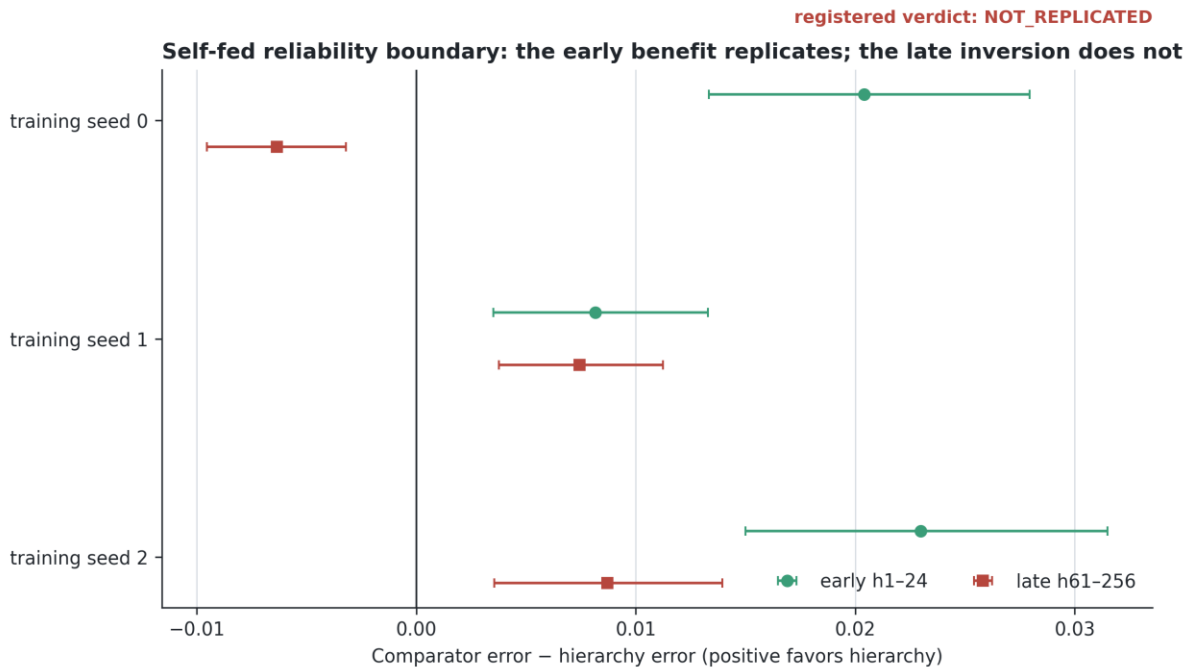


Figure 5. The early hierarchy benefit is positive at all three seeds. The registered late negative direction occurs only at seed 0 and reverses at both new seeds, producing the `NOT_REPLICATED` verdict.

4.6 Sampler and inference-allocation robustness

E7c evaluates seven frozen seed-0 diffusion checkpoints on a separate purpose-locked LoopMom robustness set. Four contrasts—896-token reach, 1,152-token interior reach–fidelity, the near-matched 1,088-token temporal-versus-1,152-token spatial package shape, and the 2,432-token flat-fidelity inversion—are crossed with five frozen NFE/sampler variants. Positive effects favor the registered candidate. The 64-token deficit favors the temporal control; this package-shape comparison is not described as exactly token matched.

All 20 point estimates retain their registered direction. The 896 reach effects range from +0.0465 to +0.0482; the 1,152 interior effects from +0.0140 to +0.0201; the package-shape effects from +0.0221 to +0.0292; and the 2,432 inversion effects from +0.0077 to +0.0122. The simultaneous family-wise lower bound is positive for every variant of the first three contrasts and for the inversion at NFE 8/16/32 with sampler seed 0. At NFE 16, the inversion remains positive but is family-wise unresolved under sampler seed 1 (+0.0098 [−0.0001,+0.0196]) and sampler seed 2 (+0.0077 [−0.0013,+0.0167]). The registered verdict is therefore **DIRECTIONALLY_ROBUST**, not `ROBUST_CI_CLEAN`.

Non-empty foreground, full-frame, background and union-mask errors favor the registered candidate in all 20 variants, as do recall and F1. Component-count diagnostics are not uniformly favorable, so the result is not described as improvement on every endpoint. This study rules out a simple explanation based on the default NFE-16 allocation or one sampling-noise realization for the observed directions. It

does not establish universal sampler invariance: it is checkpoint-only, uses seed-0 predictors, one frozen codec and one procedural dataset family.

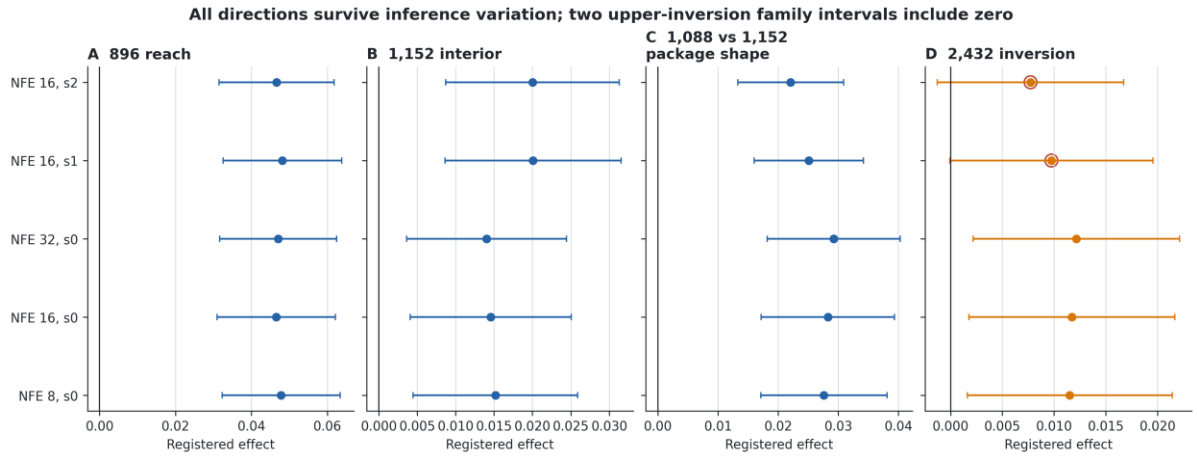


Figure 6. All 20 point estimates preserve their registered direction. Open circles mark the two 2,432-token upper-inversion effects whose simultaneous family intervals include zero under alternate sampler seeds.

4.7 Robustness to an independently trained latent codec

E7a changes the entire latent representation by training a second codec seed, recomputing codec-specific normalization and retraining the same seven seed-0 diffusion predictors. It is therefore a whole-codec intervention—not an isolated test of reconstruction error, latent scale or one normalization component. The new 500×200 LoopMom set is purpose-locked and shared by all four original-codec controls and four alternate-codec contrasts. The eight effects form one studentized max-statistic clip-cluster family.

Codec	896 reach	1,152 interior	1,088 vs 1,152 shape	2,432 inversion
Original	+0.0494 [0.0339, 0.0649]	+0.0283 [0.0169, 0.0397]	+0.0253 [0.0163, 0.0343]	+0.0150 [0.0065, 0.0235]
Alternate	+0.0521 [0.0374, 0.0669]	+0.0439 [0.0310, 0.0569]	+0.0112 [0.0039, 0.0184]	+0.0079 [−0.0006, 0.0165]

All eight point estimates retain the registered direction. Seven simultaneous lower bounds are positive; only the alternate-codec 2,432-token inversion includes zero. The registered verdict is therefore **CODEC_DIRECTIONALLY_ROBUST**. The alternate codec strengthens the lower/interior reach effects but descriptively shrinks the package-shape and upper-inversion effects. Because codec seed is not an inferential replicate, those changes locate sensitivity without identifying its latent-space cause.

The upper comparison is metric-sensitive in precision, not reversed: non-empty foreground MSE still favors flat by +0.0097 [0.0019, 0.0177], while full-frame, background, union, precision/F1 and component-count intervals are mixed. No third codec, predictor seed, arm or endpoint was selected after observation.

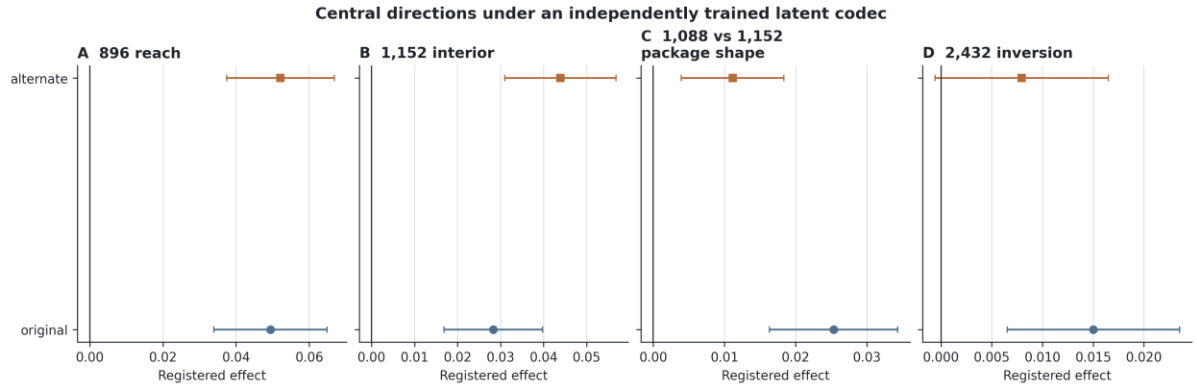


Figure 7. Original- and alternate-codec effects under one simultaneous eight-effect family. All point estimates preserve direction; the alternate-codec upper inversion is the sole interval crossing zero.

4.8 Privileged pose-indexed raw-memory reference

E8a asks how much error remains when access is made explicit. It builds a frozen world-coordinate mosaic from raw warm-up pixels and queries it using exact saved viewport positions. It receives information unavailable to the neural predictors: raw pixel storage and all future query poses. It is therefore an access reference, not a token-matched architecture comparison, learned retrieval baseline or natural-video result.

Registered effect	Estimate	Simultaneous 95% CI
Raw K14 minus raw K48	+0.0723	[+0.0548, +0.0898]
Raw K38 minus raw K48	+0.0210	[+0.0096, +0.0325]
`hier-min` minus raw K48	+0.1219	[+0.1031, +0.1407]
`hier-long` minus raw K48	+0.1368	[+0.1190, +0.1545]
`strided-flat` minus raw K48	+0.1134	[+0.0944, +0.1324]
`flat-c2` minus raw K48	+0.1310	[+0.1122, +0.1498]

The K48 mosaic attains foreground MSE 0.0494, full-frame MSE 0.0027 and foreground recall 0.8438, versus foreground MSE 0.1628–0.1862 for the four registered neural references. Every neural-to-K48 point estimate and simultaneous lower bound is positive, giving the preregistered verdict **RAW_ACCESS_CEILING_CI_CLEAN**. The raw-span diagnostics are also positive: K48 improves over both

K14 and K38. The K38 saturation condition is not met. Median stored world coverage increases from 80 columns at K6 to 154 at K48; mean future-crop observed coverage increases from 0.454 to 0.809. Observed pixels are reproduced exactly, while unobserved columns use the frozen training-only row prior.

This closes a useful explanatory gap. Large error remains in the learned self-fed systems even when their context can geometrically reach the relevant past; exact addressing and lossless storage can remove much of it on this static world. The result does not show that hierarchy is unnecessary or that a raw mosaic is deployable: the mosaic has privileged poses, no token budget, no learned dynamics, no decoder loss and no self-fed state. It instead separates the potential value of explicit access from the measured neural package frontier.

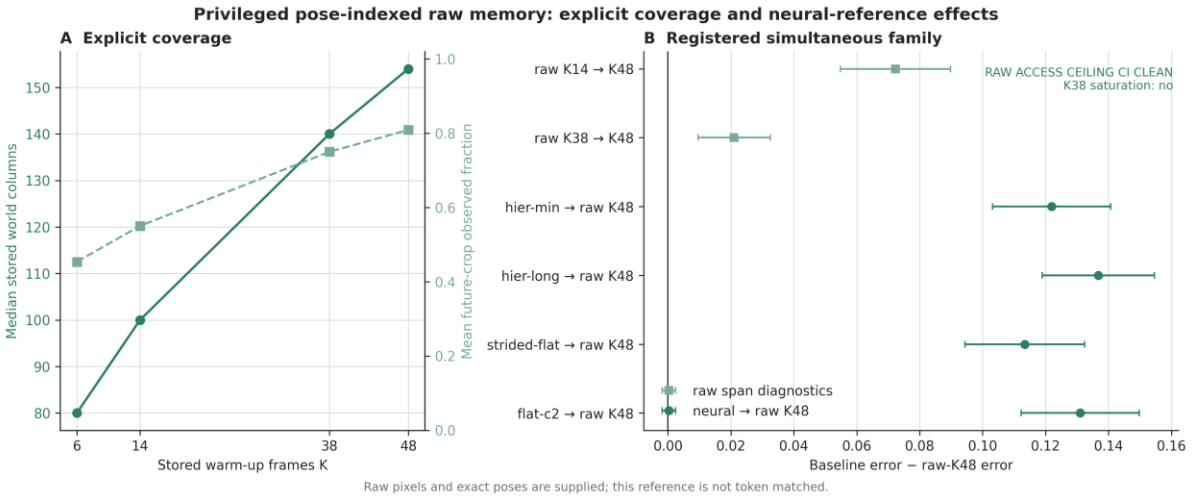


Figure 8. Left: stored-world and future-crop coverage as the raw warm-up span increases. Right: the registered simultaneous family. All six lower bounds are positive; the four circular neural-to-K48 effects determine the clean ceiling verdict.

4.9 External boundary: persistent-object long Moving-MNIST

E6 tests whether the reach–fidelity account survives the recognizable Moving-MNIST setting [Srivastava et al., 2015], with persistent digit identities, collisions and 300-frame self-fed prediction. The comparison uses three training seeds, a 48-frame warm-up, matched 1,152-token flat and hierarchical packages, an official train/test glyph split, generator-saved object identity and trajectory, one-to-one Hungarian assignment, explicit missed/extra-object accounting, and a protected 100-clip holdout. Because three co-primary endpoints are losses and two are scores, signs are harmonized as

$$\Delta_m = \begin{cases} m_{\text{flat}} - m_{\text{hier}}, & m \in \{\text{foregroundMSE}, \text{unionMSE}, \text{trajectoryerror}\}, \\ , m_{\text{hier}} - m_{\text{flat}}, & m \in \{\text{identityaccuracy}, \text{coverage}\}. \end{cases}$$

Positive effects below therefore favor hierarchy without changing the underlying endpoint denominators or paired records. All 15 intervals belong to one preregistered studentized max-statistic clip-cluster family.

Seed	Foreground MSE	Union MSE	Trajectory error	Identity accuracy	Coverage
0	+0.0036 [−0.0074,+0.0146]	+0.0102 [+0.0019,+0.0185]	+2.4786 [+0.2130,+4.7443]	−0.0762 [−0.1106,−0.0418]	+0.0304 [+0.0016,+0.0591]
1	−0.0031 [−0.0127,+0.0065]	+0.0122 [+0.0052,+0.0192]	+1.4223 [−1.0646,+3.9092]	−0.0561 [−0.0934,−0.0188]	+0.0159 [−0.0163,+0.0482]
2	−0.0024 [−0.0131,+0.0083]	+0.0169 [+0.0093,+0.0245]	+4.1325 [+1.5271,+6.7380]	−0.0647 [−0.0955,−0.0338]	+0.0498 [+0.0161,+0.0834]

The absolute values are important because both packages remain far from solved:

Seed	Arm	Union MSE ↓	Trajectory error ↓	Identity accuracy ↑	Object coverage ↑
0	flat / hierarchy	0.6861 / 0.6759	42.19 / 39.71	0.214 / 0.138	0.619 / 0.650
1	flat / hierarchy	0.6901 / 0.6779	40.20 / 38.77	0.244 / 0.188	0.646 / 0.662
2	flat / hierarchy	0.6931 / 0.6763	43.79 / 39.65	0.222 / 0.158	0.599 / 0.649

The registered verdict is **MIXED_BOUNDARY**. Union-mask error favors hierarchy on every seed. Trajectory and coverage favor hierarchy cleanly on seeds 0 and 2 and remain directionally positive but unresolved on seed 1. Missed objects are lower and full-frame/background error is lower for hierarchy at every seed as secondary descriptive evidence. Conversely, identity accuracy favors flat context with simultaneous intervals wholly below zero at every seed. Foreground-only error is unresolved and changes sign.

This is a scientifically useful division of labor. The coarse stream better preserves spatial support—where an object is, whether it remains represented, and how its trajectory continues—but loses fine glyph information needed to preserve what the object is. Because identity uses a fixed ground-truth object denominator, the result is not explained by selecting only detected survivors. It is consistent with the article's reach–fidelity account, but it is not a replication of LoopMom's exact observability mechanism or evidence of natural-video transfer.

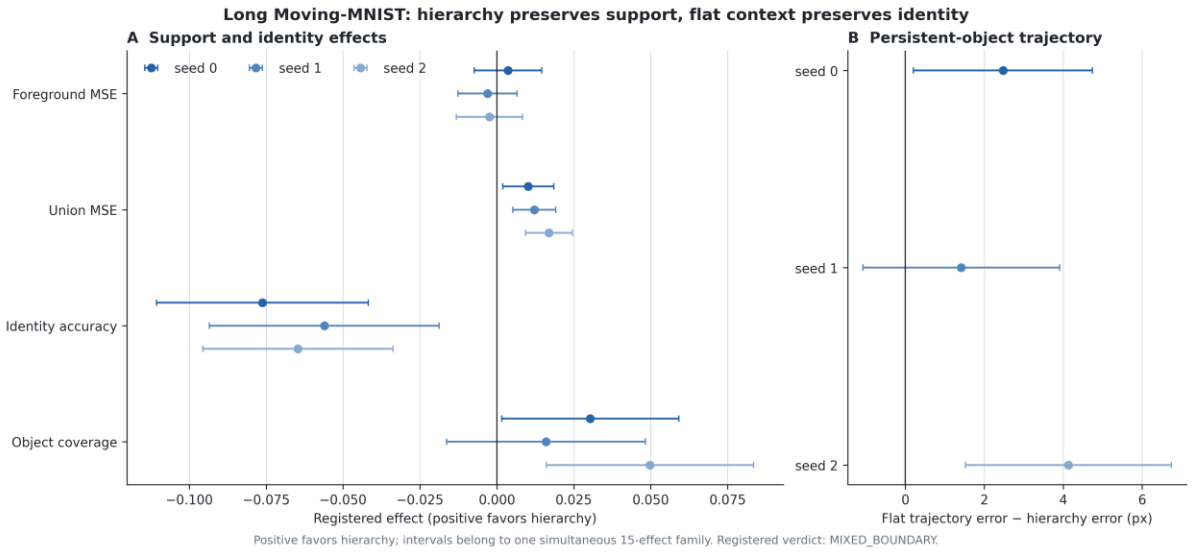


Figure 9. Registered E6 simultaneous effects. Positive favors hierarchy. The support and continuity endpoints separate from identity fidelity, producing the preregistered mixed verdict.

5. Reproducibility and evidence availability

5.1 Provenance and validation

Every confirmatory or robustness dataset has a purpose string, generation seed, split indices and SHA-256 hashes in a committed manifest. Opening a protected dataset requires the matching purpose-specific access log. Each model or evaluation cell has a content-addressed `RunSpec`, immutable metric artifact, checkpoint provenance, source commit, declared GPU-hour ceiling and cloud run. The evidence index `artifacts/rft_claim_artifact_index.json` binds the manuscript's central claims to frozen result JSON files; `docs/draft/RFT_GENERATED_TABLES.md` is regenerated from those artifacts rather than transcribed by hand.

Training checkpoints store model, optimizer and EMA state. New-regime runs additionally record Python, NumPy and Torch RNG state; older resumed runs are described as distributionally reproducible rather than trajectory-identical where those states were absent. CPU gates check dataset hashes, arm interfaces, batch-index and fixed-seed numerical parity where legacy and refactored paths must be combined. W&B is a cloud mirror and health record, not the source of truth: conclusions are recomputed from immutable local NPZ/JSON artifacts. GPU-hour accounting is wall-clock ownership time, including evaluation, pilots, failures and retries.

The repository archive contains the generator, training and evaluation code, frozen protocols, authorization gates, exact command wrappers, access logs, generated tables and figure scripts. Large datasets and checkpoints are identified by cryptographic hashes even when distributed separately.

Smoke tests cannot overwrite canonical result names, and a completed study is not accepted unless its independent completion validator passes.

5.2 Code, data, model and licence availability

The source-code release is licensed under the MIT License recorded in the repository. That software licence does not automatically cover third-party datasets, pretrained assets, or their derivatives. The submission package must therefore give a separate licence/terms row for MNIST, OpenSTL inputs, generated LoopMom data, persistent-object Moving-MNIST, codecs and model checkpoints.

The local release manifest already identifies evidence artifacts, datasets and checkpoints by cryptographic hash. A public-availability claim will be made only after the corresponding archive is deposited. **Review-edition author action (administrative, not a missing scientific result):** insert the public repository URL, archive DOI or stable URL, packaged filenames, exact byte sizes, per-package licences, and checkpoint/data download commands. Until those fields are inserted and tested from a clean download, the defensible wording is “hash-identified and preserved in the research release,” not “publicly available.”

5.3 Ethics and data-governance statement

The reported studies recruit no human participants and collect no new personal, clinical, private, or user-generated data. They use procedurally generated scenes and established digit benchmark assets. Human-subject review is therefore not applicable to the experimental design, subject to the institution's required submission wording. Third-party dataset terms and redistribution rights remain licence questions and must be verified in the availability statement rather than being inferred from the code licence.

6. Boundaries and positioning

The study does not establish a universal hierarchy advantage, a unique token crossing, a pure B1 context-stride effect, regression equivalence, information-theoretic necessity, natural-video generalization, a trust law, or valid legacy Phase C object conclusions. Moving-MNIST 10-to-10 and TaxiBJ are descriptive boundary/competence anchors rather than equivalence or re-entry evidence. The corrected persistent-object long Moving-MNIST study is valid but remains an external synthetic boundary: it supports neither a universal hierarchy ranking nor LoopMom-mechanism or natural-video generalization. E7a supports whole-codec directional robustness conditional on predictor seed 0; it does not establish component-level codec causality or universal representation invariance. E8a is a privileged static-world access reference. Because it receives exact future poses and raw warm-up pixels without a matched token or inference budget, it cannot support a model-ranking, efficiency or natural-generalization claim.

Prior work already studies slow latent state, compressed trajectory memory, retrieval, memory benchmarks and autoregressive mismatch [CW-VAE; FDM; TECO; recent spatial-memory world models; WorldPack; MBench; CaR/SceneFly; MemLearner; GIM-World; Self Forcing]. The novelty is narrower: an analytic observability instrument, matched-budget rate-versus-resolution tests, measured inversions, pair-specific reach bands, an outcome-independent replication test of self-fed reliability, and a frozen simultaneous inference-robustness family.

A strong follow-up would use paired counterfactual worlds identical over the short visible context but differing in an off-screen texture/barcode that determines re-entry. Crossing static/dynamic hidden content with low/high spatial detail, plus classical pose-indexed and learned retrieval baselines, would test whether the preferred package follows the information structure.

7. Conclusion

This work is a controlled search for operating boundaries, not proof that one architecture always wins. On the untouched LoopMom holdout, hierarchy is confirmed where a token-matched flat window cannot address the re-entry past; at larger tested budgets, full-resolution fidelity recovers the advantage. The tested packages reach 48 frames with 2.67–3.43 times fewer context tokens than a dense fine-history package, but this is a reach-efficiency result rather than an equivalence claim.

The supporting studies narrow the scope rather than changing the conclusion. Temporal packaging is stable across five diffusion training seeds but not under the regression head; sampler and codec interventions retain the principal directions while reducing precision for the upper inversion; and the proposed late trust boundary fails to replicate. Privileged pose-indexed raw access shows that including information in context is not the same as addressing and reusing it reliably. Persistent-object Moving-MNIST adds the complementary fidelity boundary: hierarchy better preserves support and continuity, whereas flat context better preserves identity, and neither system solves the task.

The practical rule is therefore conditional: buy enough reach to include the relevant past, preserve the detail the task needs, and evaluate storage, addressing and self-fed reuse as different failure modes. Within the tested regime, hierarchy buys reach and flat context buys fidelity.

Supplementary configuration and cost tables

S1. Common rollout training and inference regimes

The rollout backbone has approximately 22.19 M trainable parameters for the flat, two-level and temporally sparse arms. The `hier3` probe adds approximately 0.30 M level-specific I/O parameters and a separately frozen top-level codec tap. B16×30k and B8×60k each process approximately 480,000 examples, but they differ in update count, grouping, gradient noise and effective EMA horizon.

Regime / head	Batch	Updates	Approx. examples	EMA	NFE per rollout step	NFE per 38-step / 152-frame rollout	Role
B16×30k diffusion	16	30,000	480,000	0.999	16 default	608 default	primary frontier and factorial regime
B8×60k diffusion	8	60,000	480,000	0.999	16 default	608 default	matched-example optimizer-regime control
B16×30k regression	16	30,000	480,000	0.999	1	38	deterministic rollout control

The corrected small single-step receipt executes only the closely matched regression (7.27 M parameters, 6,000 steps) and diffusion (7.53 M, 8,000 steps) heads. The 7.28 M energy head was instantiated by that harness but was not an executed result cell. Energy-based evidence instead comes from the separate official-code 14.66 M-parameter S1/S2 capability study. For best-of-8, regression consumes eight MC-dropout evaluations per record; diffusion consumes eight times its declared per-candidate DDIM NFE. Total inference work is therefore unequal.

Per-candidate NFE	Regression best-of-8 fg-MSE	Diffusion best-of-8 fg-MSE	Total regression / diffusion evaluations per record
4	0.0680	0.0546	8 / 32
8	0.0680	0.0514	8 / 64
16	0.0680	0.0503	8 / 128

This frozen two-batch sweep is an inference-allocation sensitivity receipt, not an equal-total-work comparison. The main six-batch, 16-NFE-per-candidate table reported in Chapter 4 yields regression 0.0664 and diffusion 0.0512; the different aggregation pool is kept explicit.

S2. Complete observed package and interface registry

“Observed” means that a completed model/evaluation cell exists. It does not make rows with different evidence roles mutually comparable. NR means that no common profiling receipt was recorded; no value is estimated.

Arm	Package / reach	Context / target / total tokens	Head and executed seeds	Training regime	Default NFE/clip	Measured step time / peak VRAM	Evidence role

Arm	Package / reach	Context / target / total tokens	Head and executed seeds	Training regime	Default NFE/clip	Measured step time / peak VRAM	Evidence role
`hier-short`	6 coarse + 6 fine / 6	480 / 320 / 800	diffusion 0–1	B16×30k	608	NR / NR	lower near-match; span below loop
`flat-short` / `flat-short-reg`	8 fine / 8	512 / 320 / 832	diffusion 0–1; regression 0	B16×30k	608 diffusion; 38 regression	NR / NR	lower comparator and B1 baseline
`hier-s2-min` / `hier-s2-min-reg`	24 stride-2 coarse + 2 fine / 48	512 / 288 / 800	diffusion 0–1; regression 0	B16×30k	608 diffusion; 38 regression	0.19–0.23 s / 3.8 GB for diffusion	B1 whole configuration
`spat18` / `spat18-reg`	18 coarse + 6 fine / 18	672 / 320 / 992	diffusion 0; regression 0	B16×30k	608 diffusion; 38 regression	NR / NR	fixed-span resolution diagnostic
`flat-min`	14 fine / 14	896 / 320 / 1,216	diffusion 0–1	B16×30k	608	NR / NR	896-token comparator
`hier-min`	48 coarse + 2 fine / 48	896 / 320 / 1,216	diffusion 0–1	B16×30k	608	NR / NR	896-token candidate
`strided-flat` / `strided-flat-reg`	11 stride-4 fine anchors + 6 fine / 48	1,088 / 320 / 1,408	diffusion 0–4; regression 0–4	B16×30k	608 diffusion; 38 regression	0.37–0.42 s / 6.3 GB for diffusion	near-matched package factorial
`flat-budget` / `reg-flat`	18 fine / 18	1,152 / 320 / 1,472	diffusion 0–2; regression 0–1	B16×30k; diffusion 0 also B8×60k	608 diffusion; 38 regression	NR / NR	1,152-token comparator
`hier-long` / `reg-long`	48 coarse + 6 fine / 48	1,152 / 320 / 1,472	diffusion 0–4; regression 0–4	B16×30k; diffusion 0 also B8×60k	608 diffusion; 38 regression	NR / NR	1,152-token candidate and package arm
`hier3`	48 top + 24 coarse + 9 fine / 48	1,152 / 336 / 1,488	diffusion 0	B16×30k	608	0.41–0.48 s / 6.5 GB	depth-plus-objective/allocation diagnostic

Arm	Package / reach	Context / target / total tokens	Head and executed seeds	Training regime	Default NFE/clip	Measured step time / peak VRAM	Evidence role
`flat-c1`	28 fine / 28	1,792 / 320 / 2,112	diffusion 0	B16×30k	608	NR / NR	intermediate frontier comparator
`hier-c1`	48 coarse + 16 fine / 48	1,792 / 320 / 2,112	diffusion 0	B16×30k	608	NR / NR	intermediate frontier candidate
`flat-c2`	38 fine / 38	2,432 / 320 / 2,752	diffusion 0	B16×30k and B8×60k	608	0.82–0.84 s / 11.8 GB in B16 profile	upper frontier comparator
`hier-c2`	48 coarse + 26 fine / 48	2,432 / 320 / 2,752	diffusion 0	B16×30k and B8×60k	608	NR / NR	upper frontier candidate
`flat-long`	48 fine / 48	3,072 / 320 / 3,392	diffusion 0–1	B8×60k	608	NR / NR	equal-reach dense comparator
`hier-rich`	48 coarse + 36 fine / 48	3,072 / 320 / 3,392	diffusion 0–1	B8×60k	608	NR / NR	equal-budget hierarchy

The following proposed cells are terminally absent: `flat-320`, `hier-s4-min`, and `hier3-reg` are **NOT_EXECUTED / OUT_OF_SCOPE**; E5b/E5c were not authorized after E5a failed to replicate; E9 is **SKIPPED_POST_FREEZE_NO_INCREMENTAL_UTILITY**; and the B1 fixed-target control is not executed because the article permanently retains a whole-configuration claim. None is “pending.”

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